

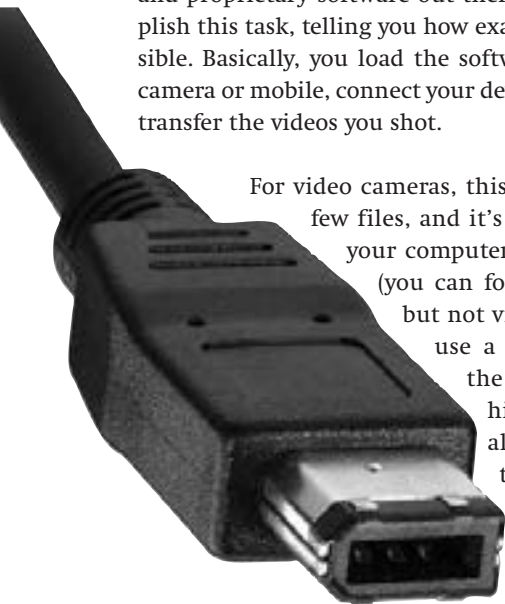
6.1 Dumping It All

Everything needs to be on your computer if you want to be able to change it, and this includes videos you've shot on your handycam, digital camera, mobile phone, etc. The only exception is what you're capturing directly onto your computer, such as through a Web cam or from streaming video or live broadcasts on TV.

In the previous chapter, you've seen how you can capture video to your hard drive. The concept is pretty simple for transferring video from your handycam / digicam / mobile to your computer. Every digital device comes with software that can be used to synchronise data between your device and your computer, including video, images, and other data files, such as MP3s, contacts, calendars, etc.

Of course, since there are too many different devices, brands and proprietary software out there that can allow you to accomplish this task, telling you how exactly this is done is quite impossible. Basically, you load the software that's provided with your camera or mobile, connect your device to your computer, and then transfer the videos you shot.

For video cameras, this isn't as easy as transferring a few files, and it's not like you can connect it to your computer through a standard USB port (you can for digital camera and mobiles, but not video cameras). You will have to use a FireWire port, also known as the IEEE 1394 interface. This is a high-speed interface that will allow you to transfer raw video to your computer for editing. Look at the pictures alongside to see what a FireWire connector and port look like, so you can make sure your video camera and PC both have



A typical Firewire connector